

In order to bring in transparency and good governance in sports bodies, the Government has formulated the National Sports Development Code of India, 2011 (NSDCI). Some of the major features of NSDCI are as under :

- (i). The President of recognized NSFs, including the Indian Olympic Association (IOA) can hold the office for a maximum period of twelve years with or without break.
- (ii). The Secretary (or by whatever other designation such as Secretary General or General Secretary by which he is referred to) and the Treasurer of any recognized NSF, including the IOA, may serve a maximum of two successive terms of four years each after which a minimum cooling off period of four years will apply to seek fresh election to either post.
- (iii). The President, the Secretary and the Treasurer of any recognized NSF, including the IOA, shall cease to hold that post on attaining the age of 70 years.

Government has taken a number of steps to ensure that all NSFs function in a transparent manner. Instructions have been issued for prevention of sexual harassment of women athletes, transparency in selection of players, prevention of age fraud etc. Instructions have also been issued to all the major NSFs to place on their website, various details of the international events held in India and abroad such as notification of selection criteria for such events well in advance along with the details of time and venue for selection, list of core probables and basis of their selection, details of coaching camps organized including venue, dates and list of participants, list of the athletes selected, performance criteria which formed the basis of selection, actual performance in terms of timing, distance, etc. and the position obtained by each athlete/team etc. These instructions have also been made an integral part of the National Sports Development Code of India.

(c) to (e) Sir, a Working Group was constituted by the Government for drafting of the National Sports Development Bill (NSDB), under the Chairmanship of Justice (Retd.) Mukul Mudgal. The Working Group submitted the initial draft of the Bill in July 2013, which was placed in public domain inviting suggestions/comments of general public and stakeholders. The draft of the Bill, incorporating the feedback received on it, has been submitted by the Working Group. The same was circulated among various Ministries/Departments of Government of India for seeking comments. More consultations are required before the Bill can be finalized.

Further, to promote sports in the country, Government has introduced a number of schemes *viz* Scheme for Promotion of Sports among persons with disabilities, Human Resource Development in sports, scheme of National Sports Development Fund, Rajiv